

Wednesday, April 30, 2025

Tomorrow, I go on my trip to Los Angeles and I am. Oh, so excited about it. Very happy to have a break from work. Long time coming. I haven't really had much. No, kind of nickel and dimed some days here and there. took a day for my friend bachelor party and I have a good time with that, but overall, it's been pretty constant for the last year or so. And honestly, I mean, last, obviously very significant break that I took was in late 2022 when Billy was born and I took parental leave off at my last company. And so, yeah, I'm very looking forward to the break. K of separate from from the vacation, though, is I have my morning check- call with my friends at work, Anne and Christy. And Anne was clearly very upset and frustrated with our boss Victoria. And Victoria was. apparently like pretty rude and consending and impolite to her on a call. And, you know, Victoria has a history of doing this. I've actually gone to HR in the past about it. I spoke to the chief HR officer about Victoria's behavior and how she has been mistreating people and talking down to them and then very aggressive and hostile and you know, Victorian never yells necessarily, but she is often pretty unkind in the way that she speaks to other people and. Victoria will kind of like misunderstand what people are saying and misinterpret what people are saying and kind of be the only one who's not on the same page as everybody else, but you will often kind of take out her frustration about this on the people that she's on calls with and frequently those people are people who report to her. And so, you know, Anne is one of them and I think Anne was saying that like, you know, Victoria had sent over a pretty cryptic email requesting that Anne do something and Anne did her best to figure it out and come prepared to the call and Other people had him weighed in. Victoria was just, you know, time after time after time, just kind of like kind of barking orders at her and questioning every single thing that she said and did. And was was just very rude and publicly so in front of like Operations leaders at the company.. And like, you know, the only concession that I can make is that Victoria is probably under pressure to try to close some deal with some client or whatever. And it involves the work that Ann does and pricing. And so that's where that kind of pressure and affect and behavior was coming from. But ultimately it was translating into her kind of mistreating aunt. And this is something that has happened like pretty consistently. Like Anne says that there are not a lot of times where she has conversations with Victoria, where Victoria does not speak to her in this way. It is almost like this universal trait. And, you know, they're part of the reason I had gone to HR in the past wasn't just for my own personal experiences, but because Victoria had spoken this way too, like other coworkers who report to her. And just overall is very hostile and aggressive and does not, you know, kind of meet people with courtesy and in politeness. Like she just just leads with like, irritability and frustration and is often very dictatorial and not collaborative about stuff. And, you know, she's really honestly managed to alien you look at. significant portion of the people that certainly report to her, but also that like that work with her elsewhere at the company and it's just getting to a point where like, you know, I've talked about this in another journal entries before, where I definitely think that it's going to whole Victoria back, but I also worry that it's going to, you know piss people off and upset them to the point where they just some want to deal with her anymore. just be fed up with being treated in the way that they treat that she treats them and they'll go and find a job somewhere else I mean like it's One of the only reasons that people might not make that decision is because of a noncommute agreements.

The bar that was if you don't like how you're being treated and spoken to at your workplace. you know, if you were hired because you were worth hiring in the first place, chances are you're going to go and take your business elsewhere. And I just have a feeling that that's what People are doing. I mean, there's Victoria's fired plenty of people that haven't worked out or that she had inherited and didn't work out. So that happened, but then... She is also made people alienated and pissed off to the point where they just don't want to work with her. They part ways with her. They initiate the parting of the ways. They don't want to invest the time and energy, certainly into appeasing her for what she's looking for, which is often cryptic and unreasonable and difficult to understand because of having Victoria communicates, but also they just don't want to deal with her personality and her kind of toxic behavior, and so they leave. And you know, I think that there is a pretty comprehensive case that can be made about so many people leaving this company as a result of direct contact with Victoria are indirectly because of things that she has said and done. And you know, I've worried wondered about this and journal about this before, but it's like, what's the other shin to drop? Like, what has to happen for her to realize that this is not acceptable and she can't treat people this way. Like, I was trying to encourage Anne that she needs to tell Victoria that it is not okay for her to speak to her this way and that she needs to check herself. And that it has nothing to do with a boss employee relationship, but it comes down to just mutual respect between human beings. And I think that that is absolutely reasonable. In fact, in the past, when I have really not appreciated the way that Victoria has spoken to me, I have had to formally call her out and tell her not in front of other people, but privately, that that I wasn't happy with how she was speaking to me. And it was not a comfortable conversation, you know, in addition to that, like, I've had to tell Victoria in the past that like, I haven't been motivated to share information with her and to open up about the challenges that I've had at work because I don't trust her and that I feel like I can't trust that she is going to respond to constructively to what I have to say is she's just going to say, well, what do you want me to do about it? And so in addition to me having to. I have had to kind of stake my claim and, you know, plant my flag in the ground in terms of respect. and demand that from her. and let her know that I will not be spoken to in this way. And, you know, I don't know if it's because Anne can sometimes come across as passive and quiet in the way that she conducts herself or what it is, but you know, I don't think that it is definitely not fair for Anne to have to deal with this. And I also don't want her to leave. Like, she is an extremely valuable person half on the team. Like she has completely overhauled the way that pricing is approached at the company. Like she is truly the expert that we need to have. And having her experience such a such a considerable amount of dissatisfaction with the way that her boss speaks to her, it's just a really big problem, you know, and then on top of that, she's my friend and I want her to be happy where she's working. And underlying all of this is that I brought Anne over. Like, I referred her from our old company. I knew that she would be great at the job, and she has succeeded. And I wanted her to come work here, but when I was going through the process of referring her, like Victoria wasn't in place yet. And so I feel like through no fault of my own, obviously, but I do feel some sense of responsibility for bringing her over into the situation in which she's having to deal with this is like a very unpleasant person. And it's not anything that it's not like, in many ways, it's not the job that I sold her. And so I just feel remiss for her having the experience that she's been having. I very much wish that she wasn't going through this. I don't want anybody to be experiencing what an experiences. Like she no person should be spoken to in the way that Victoria speaks to them. That's part of why I went to Vivian, the chief HR officer in the first place, because you know, I didn't like what I had seen the previous interactions between Victoria and

other people on the team and at the company and I wanted it to be known. No, it's also getting into the point where I'm thinking that it would be useful for, you know, people to surreptitiously record Victoria while she's speaking so that we have proof of her behavior. And of course, if she knew that she was being recorded, I'm sure she wouldn't conduct herself in that same way. Um So I feel like, you know, something that I think about is like, with a what they say in V for vendetta, which is like, people should not be afraid of their government government should be afraid of its people. And that's how I feel about this situation. Like, people should not be getting like clenched stomachs because they know that they're going to have a one-on-one with their boss. If anything, people should feel excited about an opportunity to interact one-on-one with their with their supervisor because that's an opportunity to kind of, you know, get support and to talk about the things that you might be having challenges with and I just feel like... I get this. I mean, I'm directly told about people's feeling of they meet with her and, you know, anticipating their meetings with her and they like they're very they're filled with fear and trepidation about it. You know, I've definitely talked about that before in terms of like my one-on-ones with her and, you know, sometimes there's an obvious example like when Denver proposal submission didn't go through properly. And we missed a couple of deadlines. Like, I had a very clear imprisoned reason to be nervous about that conversation and it ended up transpiring better than I thought it would. But then there's just like, you know, her behavior is often unpredictable. And, you know, what what's occurring to me is something that I've kind of noticed in the past where it's just like, if she is under pressure about one thing or another, she will absolutely externalize that under other people. Like she does not know how to control her feelings of stress and anxiety without just externalizing them onto the people around her. And like, while I do want to give grace to any human being who does this, because like, that's all understandable, humans, you know, we are all humans like that. That is a somewhat understandable response, what it isn't is excusable and what it's definitely not excusable is in the context where your supervisor is speaking to you in this way and you feel like you're constantly in fear of how she was going to address you. And it's like it's not the kind of existential fear where you feel like you're going to be potentially fired at any moment, although I do think that some of my team who report to Victoria are also genuinely worried about that. But in the sense of. Like, I don't want to have to have this interaction with this person because I always feel angry or emotional or, you know, some kind of pretty strong negative emotion every single time I speak to this person. And who wants to work at that kind of an environment? You know, there's some people that I work with where, you know, because of the nature of the work they do, I know that in interacting with them, it might mean that I end up having more on my plate from a workload standpoint, and that's fine. Like, that's just the nature of the job. If I didn't have salespeople or people bringing me potential opportunities to try to win, then I wouldn't have a job. That's not what I'm worried about. It's not even like.. I have my 10-on- ones with Victoria and inevitably it will create like extra, like bigger picture, long-term work for me to try to put my energy towards. That's totally fine. You know, it's that is actually the kind of support, the bigger picture support that I don't mind getting from Victoria, because it is showing that she does have some kind of a direction in which things are going. It's not just, when we get on the phone, we're just talking about the day-to-day stuff. And I have no clue which direction she's steering the ship in. So it's not like a work load standpoint. It's a fear of, I'm going to get on the phone, and then I'm just going to I'm just going to get haranged. Like I'm going to be criticized and hell responsible for things that are are not my fault. Like I will be mistreated and spoken to in a way that is unfair and I'll feel very frustrated afterwards and then I'll have to come down from that. Because how are you

supposed to how are you supposed to get good work done when that is how you feel a lot of the time? If you are often in a fight or flight situation, you know that in having a conversation with somebody that there's a chance you're going to come out on the other side of it feeling like you've been derated for something that's not your fault, that somebody's going to condescend to you because she herself is not expressing herself in a way that makes sense or is articulate. And you are not the only person who feels like this, but other people share your confusion as well. And yet she still makes you feel like you're stupid for not understanding her and she externalizes her frustration with her own inability to be understood by other people. In some ways, it's actually quite juvenile. It reminds me of how my two-year-old will be trying to like tell me something. She'll be trying to use words or mispronouncing things and I won't really, and she'll just repeat herself over and over because she doesn't know what to say. She doesn't quite grasp how to articulate herself and then she'll get frustrated and, you know, yell or cry or whatever. Like, that is often how Victoria behaves. She will take out her frustration on her, her lack of a grasp of how to get out what she has on her mind. And it just turns into. being really short, really brusque, really dismissive, and publicly so. Like she will do this to you in front of other people. In fact, she is almost more likely to do this in front of other people. Like the odds of her.. the odds of her conducting herself more charitably one-on-one are a lot greater than if she has an audience. It almost feels like whether she realizes it or not, it almost feels like she is performing in a way. Like she is she has in this situation with Anne. She has this audience in Dave Angel and Dan Gensinger in operations where she's communicating with Anne and it's not working and so then she kind of publicly vents her frustrations and anger at Anne not understanding what she's saying. Almost for the benefit of the people around her. Like, by publicly chastising Anne in this way, she knows that she's going to like make more of an impact. In fact, I've even heard Victoria like make comments in the past about how, you know, I should plan to be, you know, gentle with my sales team members because she's kind of like giving them the business about one thing or another earlier in that week. It's It's almost like this. It's okay. There's almost like this weird pleasure that she seems to take in kind of laying people out. And this disregard of, you know, like, there's one thing to be competitive and say, like, I didn't come here to make friends. Like, nobody ever required anybody to become best friends with their coworkers. Like, that's just, that's not in everybody's personality. That's not everybody's job description, like Victoria's an executive. It often is a good thing to have, you know, firmer boundaries between yourself and your colleagues and the people that report to you just because you will sometimes have to ask those people to do things that they don't want to do. But, you know, it's one thing to maintain that boundary, but it's another to actively be hostile to people all the time. It's almost like get off on it to feel like you're kind of reveling in your power in that way. And it's just very worrisome. And I'm concerned about the the ongoing tenure of the people around us. You know, regardless of whether Victoria is ultimately making an impact on the company's ability to bring in revenue. And to be honest, I don't have full visibility into that. one way or another, so I can't speak to that directly, but at what cost? Like, if you manage to alienate every single person that works for you or works with you, because it's not even just the people that report to her. You know, I have anecdotal conversations with people who have to cooperate with Victoria, who are in different departments or in operations. Like D, Dunn. Like Michael McDade, I think a huge part of why he left the company is because of the way that Victoria behaves. You know, he was fed up, and I'm sure he got his other reasons that I'm not aware of, but I do know for a fact that that is something that he really struggles with. And I witnessed her. B very unfair and unreasonable towards him. Like, when we were working on

the BMW bed, Michael did the brave thing by standing up to Victoria and saying, like, this is not something that we should be working on. Like, he did the sidewalk. He, he got firsthand view of what it would involve, and it's just not something that's in our wheelhouse. In Victoria was so dedicated to bringing in the sale, and she had a hammer, everything looked like a nail. She was not interested in hearing anybody else's point of view. And it was only when, you know, Michael really stood firm and held onto the fact that like, actually, no, like, this is not possible. We are not going to be able to make this work, that we finally had to scotch the bit, but Victoria was so, I think, self-conscious about how hardship and pushing for it when in reality, she didn't truly understand the scope of what was involved and was just dead set on making a big splash. Like, I think Victoria really loved the idea of potentially bringing in a sail that had a big price tag attached to it, like not bidding on something when she could have had numbers on the board, even though it required very little of her and would ultimately be a poor fit for the company, that seems to be her bottom line. She does not care who she has to tear down or alienate or potentially endanger the company's ability to actually deliver on its promises operationally in the process. And I think that even even setting aside interpersonal conflicts that she is creating, which she is most definitely doing on a regular basis, she could potentially jeopardize the company's reputation by trying to sign us up for something and then failing to deliver on it. You know, if we ultimately are able to secure a win, you know, good for her, but she has a very cavalier attitude towards whether or not we are truly able to operate it. And I do understand that there is a natural pushing pull between sales and operations, and you have to find happy medium. But Victoria, a happy medium is not something that is in her vocabulary. Victoria is not happy with the medium. Victoria wants her way or the highway, and I think she gets off on the power trip that she has, that she's been going through. You know, it kind of manifests itself in the way that she presents herself. Like there is very much this like boss babe attitude that she is kind of reveling in. You know, I think that Victoria's a little power drunk on the fact that she's, you know, still in her mid 30s in his zombie executive team. Even going so far as her saying that she is more or less or virtually achieve revenue officer, even though that is not actually her title, which is executive vice president. And in fact, I'm sure it burns her a little bit, but that isn't the title that she was given. You know, that is what matters, to her. And if she has to tear down the people around her who support her, who report to her, and kind of make her job possible in the process, she does not care. But I think in a lot of ways, she poses an existential threat to this company because people, there will be attrition from good people who are just fed up with working with her in dealing with her interpersonal behavior and then potentially also putting the company in danger of failing to deliver on something that was promised through her refusal to accept no for an answer when it comes to certain sales opportunities. I mean, just take a look at the target bid where it was only when Bryson got involved at the last minute that it was decided we were going to just be pursuing Hawaii instead of the entire portfolio. Victoria was absolutely gung-ho on going after the biggest part of the pie as possible. And she may not have been the only one, but she was definitely leading the charge, and she is an executive in that position. Like, I get that you want to aim big. ambition is something that is useful in a salesperson. Can't be too modest, otherwise, you won't treat for the things that you truly have a good opportunity to win. But she is out of control. Both in the scope of what she's trying to go after, and definitely in the way that she has behaving towards her coworkers.